

PAGE 1 (SINGLE SPLASH)

INT. PSYCHIATRIC TESTING FACILITY - DAY

A mission control type room filled with computers where a LAB TECHNICIAN in a white lab coat sits in a chair as he looks out through a large window at a row of four cubicles below. A DIRECTOR in a dark suit stands next to him, observing.

At each cubicle sits a person wearing VR goggles. A middle-aged LATINO MAN is sweating buckets, upset. A skinny METH HEAD guy with stringy hair is passed out, goggles still on. A middle aged HOUSEWIFE has the goggles off, crying profusely. And a gorgeous raven-haired woman smokes a cigarette, seems to be enjoying the work.

SUBJECT: ASTRID ST JAMES: "In 1963 Yale University psychologist Stanley Milgram ran an experiment where one group of test subjects ("teachers") would quiz other test subjects ("learners") about general knowledge. If the learner got an answer wrong, the teacher would be instructed to zap them with ever stronger electric shocks. The results proved that ordinary people - if instructed to do so by a person in a presumed position of authority - would torture complete strangers. In the original Milgram experiment the learners were paid actors. In this contemporary rerun of the experiment, the testers could torture the learners in a VR world where there were no limits on the severity of the pain they could inflict..."

PAGE 2 (FOUR PANEL)

1. INT. TESTING FACILITY CLOSE UP

The DIRECTOR (GELLMAN) leans down to advice the LAB TECHNICIAN. He's about 60, very professorial.

DIRECTOR
These subjects are toast. Anyone
left?

LAB TECHNICIAN
Well, there's the girl...

2. INT. CUBICLE

ASTRID wears the goggles, smiling, excited, presses a button on a console.

ASTRID
That is incorrect. Your correction
will be 700 volts.

3. INT. VR WORLD - A MAN CONNECTED TO WIRES

The MAN screams in pain as his body is convulsed by the electric shock.

MAN
Please make it stop!

4. INT TESTING FACILITY CLOSE UP

DIRECTOR and LAB TECHNICIAN watch this, react in amazement.

DIRECTOR
Name?

LAB TECHNICIAN
Astrid St. James. She ruthless.

DIRECTOR
Get to my office. She's the one.

PAGE 3-4 (DOUBLE SPLASH) - FIVE PANELS

1. EXT. UNIVERSITY CAMPUS - DAY (BIG PANEL)

ASTRID walks. Smoking a cigarette. Girls seem afraid of her. Guys look like they want to fuck her.

RANDOM GUY STUDENT
Hey Astrid, you want to hook up again?

ASTRID
Learn how to fuck like a big boy first.

RANDOM FEMALE 1
Bitch.

RANDOM FEMALE 2
Talk about damaged goods.

2. INT. GELLMAN'S OFFICE - DAY

Diplomas on the walls. Very serious. ASTRID sits opposite GELLMAN, still smoking.

GELLMAN
This is a non-smoking building.

3. INT. C/U ON ASTRID - CONTINUOUS

ASTRID extinguishes the cigarette on her knee.

ASTRID
So what's this weird little meeting about?

4. INT. C/U ON GELLMAN - CONTINUOUS

GELLMAN

You represent a unique blend of sociopathy and psychopathy. And narcissism, of course. Have you ever killed anyone?

5. INT. C/U ON ASTRID - CONTINUOUS

ASTRID

Killed, no. Not yet. I've hurt some people...a bit...

PAGE 5 (FOUR PANEL)

1. INT. ASTRID'S ROOM - AFTERNOON

ASTRID whips a submissive wearing a latex suit and a mouth clamp.

ASTRID

It licks and begs or it gets the whip again!

2. EXT. SCHOOL CLASSROOM - CONTINUOUS

ASTRID wipes blood off her hand. A female student lays on the ground, blood gushing out of her nose. A teacher and students stand around, terrified.

ASTRID

What's the big deal? She asked for it.

3. INT. SEX PARLOR - EVENING

ASTRID wears a dominatrix uniform. Huge strap on. Three grown middle aged men cower on the floor, in pain, terrified.

ASTRID

Are you not entertained?

4. EXT. SMALL GROUP OF STUDENTS - AFTERNOON

ASTRID sits at a table with a fellow female student who is crying hysterically.

ASTRID

Of course your boyfriend is fucking other girls. You have any idea how boring you are to him?

PAGE 6 (FOUR PANELS)

1. INT. GELLMAN'S OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

GELLMAN standing, hands ASTRID (sitting) a piece of paper.

GELLMAN
Because of your unique profile...

2. INT. C/U ASTRID

As she exhales smoke.

ASTRID
You mean I'm a psychopath?

3. INT. SIDE SHOT 1:1 - CONTINUOUS

ASTRID and GELLMAN face to face.

GELLMAN
Not yet. But there's training for that.

4. INT. C/U ON PIECE OF PAPER - CONTINUOUS

POV ASTRID of the SOK logo and barcode. Logo reads: "The Most Advanced Murder & Mayhem Training. Est. 1396"

GELLMAN
You have a gift, Astrid. Don't squander it.

PAGE 7 (FIVE PANELS)

1. EXT. PARK NEAR UNIVERSITY - AFTERNOON

ASTRID sits in quiet contemplation, looks at the invitation. A fellow student nearby asks...

FELLOW
Hey Astrid, you going to class?

2. FULL SHOT ASTRID SNAPS A SCAN OF THE BARCODE - CONTINUOUS

ASTRID (O.S.)
Nope. Never again.

3. EXT. WIDER SHOT - PARK

A BLACK LIMO has pulled up 50 yards away.

ASTRID
That was fast.

4. EXT. NEXT TO LIMO - CONTINUOUS

A VALET (black suit, very post modern look, weird outfit) has opened the car door.

VALET
Ms. St. Claire, welcome to the
Society of Killers.

5. INT. INSIDE LIMO - MOMENTS LATER

(Large panel) ASTRID sits the the back seat while the VALET merges onto the highway.

ASTRID
Such fancy treatment. Guess I'm
special.

VALET
You are. But there are others...

PAGE 8 (SINGLE SPLASH)

1. INT. SUPERMAX HOLDING PEN

Eight prison GUARDS dressed in battle equipment stand around a cage set up in the middle of a large industrial. Like SILENCE OF THE LAMBS. Video camera on a tripod. INSIDE THE CELL sitting in a lotus position is...

SUBJECT: QUENTIN LAROUCHE: "MAOA Warrior Gene, predisposed to hyper violence, victim of horrific child abuse, trauma to frontal lobes, low skin conductance, convicted of massacre of 23 innocent bystanders at open-air market in Afghanistan, 0% probability of rehabilitation, recommended lifetime solitary confinement."

PAGE 9-10 (FIVE PANELS)

1. INT. HOLDING PEN

C/U on lead guard, BENDIX. A buzzcut Martine type.

BENDIX
Well, Larouche - you want the easy
way or the hard way?

2. INT. C/U QUENTIN - CONTINUOUS

Looks up, weird sardonic smile, pure psycho.

QUENTIN
Harder the better.

3. INT. CLOSE SHOT ALL THE GUARDS - CONTINUOUS

Despite all the armaments and weaponry, these guys look totally afraid.

GUARD 1

Fuck me.

GUARD 2

I knew he's say that.

GUARD 3

Basket case.

GUARD 4

Let's do this.

4. INT. INSIDE THE CAGE - MOMENTS LATER

The GUARDS all converge and wrestle QUENTIN to the floor.

BENDIX

That was easy...

5. INT. C/U QUENTIN - CONTINUOUS

In the greatest mood ever...

QUENTIN

Was it?

PAGE 11-12 (DOUBLE SPLASH)

1. INT. SUPERMAX HOLDING PEN

QUENTIN's attacks are overlapped (4 snapshots of time). GUARD 1 gets his face crushed with one punch. GUARD 2 gets his back snapped like a twig. GUARD 3 gets slammed against the cage, teeth and blood spew out. GUARD 4 gets hoisted up effortlessly and THROWN across the room and lands limp.

2. EXT. SUPERMAX - CONTINUOUS

BENDIX has an electric cattle prod in one hand, taser in the other.

BENDIX

Come get some, psycho-boy.

3. INT. MEDIUM SHOT

BENDIX zaps QUENTIN, electrical sparks fly everywhere.

4. INT. C/U QUENTIN - CALM AND UNFAZED

QUENTIN
That tickled...

5. INT. MEDIUM SHOT - CONTINUOUS

QUENTIN tackles BENDIX.

TWO SMALL FRAMES

6. QUENTIN bites into BENDIX's thigh, removes a huge chunk of meat. Blood spews everywhere.

7. Reaction BENDIX in agony...

BENDIX
AGH!!!!!!!!!!

PAGE 12-13 (THREE PANELS)

1. INT. SECURITY TOWER OVERLOOKING CAGE

The WARDEN looks down at all the bloodshed and carnage. Phone in his ear.

WARDEN
You want him, you got him. I never
want to see his face again.

2. LIMO

VALET is on the phone. ASTRID in the back seat.

VALET
Great. ETA is 20 minutes.

3. ON ASTRID, who knows there will be a stop to pick up another psycho like her.

ASTRID
Now it's a party.

PAGE 14 (SINGLE SPLASH)

INT. WHEAT FIELD - EVENING

Some sort of religious ritual. Candles. Crucifixes. A desperate family on their knees. The mother offers up her SMALL BALD CHILD (leukemia), laying limp in her arms, to...

SUBJECT: SAMARA ASTASIAN: "Gang-raped at 12, resulting in highly abnormal theta brain wave utility, increased blood circulation to hands with heat conductivity in excess of 120 degrees, became a faith-healer with the gift of touch, a complete fraud."

SAMARA's hands are reaching for the child...

MOTHER
Sister Samara, we beseech thee, cure
our baby! Remove satan's scourge!

SAMARA
I shall heal this child...

PAGE 14 (THREE PANELS)

1. FIELD - WIDER SHOT

SAMARA's MOTHER stands watching off to the sidelines, running
a credit card through a swipe on her phone.

SAMARA'S MOTHER
Hold on, Samara, honey. Says payment
was declined.

2. REACTION MOTHER AND FATHER

Astonished and crestfallen.

KID'S MOTHER
(To husband)
You didn't pay the credit card?!

KID'S FATHER
I did! I swear I did!

3. C/U on SAMARA looking at her watch.

SAMARA
Let's put a pin in that, shall we?

PAGE 15 (FIVE PANELS)

1. INT. CAR

SAMARA drives. Her MOTHER next to her.

SAMARA'S MOTHER
These people must think we run a
charity.

SAMARA
I got a call today. An invitation.

2. EXT. OVERHEAD SHOT CAR DRIVING DOWN ISOLATED COUNTRY
ROAD

SAMARA'S MOTHER
You don't have time for any
invitations. Eye on the prize,
sweetie.

3. INT. CAR - EXTREME C/U ON SAMARA

SAMARA
I don't want the prize anymore,
mother.

4. INT. CAR - EXTREME C/U ON HER MOTHER

SAMARA'S MOTHER
You crazy? You're a cash-cow, honey.
You're going to do exactly what I
say you're going to do...

5. INT. WIDER SHOT - BOTH IN FRAME

SAMARA has plunged a knife into her mother's throat. Blood
splattered all over the windshield, etc.

SAMARA
No, not any more.

PAGE 16 (THREE PANELS)

1. EXT. ISOLATED COUNTRY ROAD - CAR PARKED

SAMARA stands next to the car, covered in blood, on her cell.

SAMARA (CONT'D)
I'm ready.

2. WIDER SHOT from behind SAMARA

A helicopter approaches to land in the adjacent field.

3. INT. HELICOPTER IN FLIGHT

SAMARA sits next to a woman who is the female version of the
VALET. Weird outfit.

FEMALE VALET
Welcome to the Society.

SAMARA
Just get me out of here...

PAGE 17-18 (DOUBLE SPLASH FOUR PANELS)

INT. UPSCALE COCKTAIL BAR IN HOTEL - AFTERNOON

1. A well-dressed man and a beautiful woman sit having cocktails. Very posh. Flirting.

SUBJECT: BRANDON THORNE: "Orphaned at 4, sexually molested at five, homeless on the streets of Brooklyn by 14, booked 46 times for theft, vandalism, male prostitution by age 18. Slept in a public library reading every book about finance available. Started his own Ponzi scheme at 22. Multi-millionaire by 25. Suspect in multiple serial killings."

BRANDON

What do you say we go up to my room?

BEAUTIFUL

Oh? What did you have in mind?

2. C/U ON BRENDAN

BRENDAN VOICE

I'd like to get to know you better...

BRENDAN THOUGHT BUBBLE

I'd like to chop you into little
tiny pieces and make a stew.

3. EXTREME C/U on BEAUTIFUL

Unbeknownst to BRANDON, she has a 2-way police radio in her ear.

BEAUTIFUL

I love to get to know you better
too.

TWO WAY RADIO SWAT LEADER (O.S.)

Heads up. Suspect is moving.

4. INT. SWAT STAKEOUT VAN IN AN ALLEY

A team of SWAT are at the ready. The SWAT LEADER wears headphones and is recording everything.

TWO WAY RADIO SWAT LEADER (CONT'D)

Hotel back entrance! STAT!

PAGE 19 (FOUR PANELS)

1. INT. BRANDON'S LUXURIOUS SUITE AT HOTEL

BEAUTIFUL (Undercover cop) and BRANDON enter.

BEAUTIFUL

Wow. You **actually** live here?

BRANDON
Among many other places.

2. INT. HOTEL CORRIDOR

The SWAT team converge on the door to BRENDAN's suite.
Battering ram at the ready.

3. INT. SUITE

C/U on BRANDON as he makes a cocktail. BEAUTIFUL in the foreground enjoying the Manhattan view out the huge windows.

BRANDON (CONT'D)
Vodka, neat?

BEAUTIFUL
Whatever's easiest.

BRANDON
Everything's easy with you, isn't it?

4. INT. SUITE

C/U on BEAUTIFUL so we see her ear piece.

BEAUTIFUL
Why complicate things, right?
(PAUSE)
Right?

TWO WAY RADIO SWAT LEADER (O.S.)
Fuck, he's onto us. Move!

PAGE 20 (FIVE PANELS)

1. INT. SUITE

SWAT burst onto the scene, guns out!

2. C/U LEAD SWAT COMMANDER

Shell-shocked with surprise and angry.

COMMANDER
Where is he?!

3. C/U BEAUTIFUL

Astonished, shocked...

BEAUTIFUL
He was...right there!

4. INT. ELEVATOR SHAFT

BRANDON uses a mountain climbing hook to zip down the elevator shaft.

5. EXT. STREET

SWAT team on the street get word...

COMMANDER (O.S.)
Suspect is moving! Repeat...!

PAGE 21 (THREE PANELS)

1. EXT STREET ALLEYWAY

BRANDON bursts out of the hotel exit into the alley to escape.

SWAT
FREEZE!

2. C/U on BRANDON

Phone rings as he realizes one side of the alley is blocked.

3. C/U on PHONE CALLED ID

SOCIETY OF KILLERS

4. EXT MEDIUM SHOT

BRANDON is on the phone. SEES a LIMO at the other alley exit. Door open. ASTRID and QUENTIN sitting inside.

VOICE (O.S.)
The FBI's been tracking you for months, Mr. Thorne. **Now** are you ready to join us?

BRANDON
I believe I am.

PAGE 22-23 (DOUBLE SPLASH FIVE PANELS)

LARGE 2-PAGE PANEL TOP

1. INT. COLLEGE CLASSROOM

A female Professor gives a lecture. Hundred students. Popular class. On the large blackboard behind her are dozens of quotes about EVIL: <https://www.azquotes.com/quotes/topics/nature-of-evil.html>

SUBJECT: FELICITY YAN: "Professor of Buddhism and world religions, atheist, parents killed by Mao, raised by hyper-

disciplinarian grandfather who used torture to teach. Specialist in Philosophy of Evil and Ming Dynasty torture protocols. Practices them in private with anyone unlucky enough to ask her out on a date."

YAN

As you can see, Evil is a purely relativistic term that is empty of all meaning without an agent and antagonist. That is all for today.

2. INT. COLLEGE HALLWAY

After class, YAN walks towards her office. A young MALE STUDENT hails her. Seems quite impressed with her.

MALE STUDENT

Ms. Yan, I hope you don't mind. I found your lecture quite thought-provoking.

YAN

Thinking about Evil is meaningless. Only by perpetrating it do we realize its potential to cleanse.

3. INT. HALLWAY

C/U ON STUDENT

MALE STUDENT

Cleanse? Cleanse what?

4. INT. HALLWAY

C/U on YAN

YAN

Want me to show you?

LARGE 2-PAGE PANEL BOTTOM

5. INT YAN'S MAKESHIFT TORTURE / PLEASURE PARLOR

The MALE STUDENT hangs upside down naked, tied, in terror, while YAN looks down at a table full of insidious torture devices.

YAN (CONT'D)

If you're thinking of calling the cops, don't bother. By the end of this, you'll thank me. Assuming you can still talk.

Her phone rings...

PAGE 24 (THREE PANELS)

1. C/U YAN on the PHONE

YAN (CONT'D)
What can you teach me that I don't
already know?

2. EXT. SOCIETY OF KILLERS MAIN CAMPUS

A very unique architectural building, super modern, in the middle of nowhere, surrounded by gates and barbed wire.

PHONE
How to kill.

3. INT. OFFICE

Full of high tech instruments, video screens, like a neurobiology lab, brain schematics, etc.

A MAN in a WHITE LAB coat stands overlooking the campus below, smokes a cigar. POV from the back; we don't see his face. He holds up his phone as he's FACETIME with YAN.

WHITE LAB COAT
Actually, let me rephrase that. How
to kill...more elegantly.

PAGE 25 (THREE PANELS)

1. INT. TORTURE CHAMBER

C/U on YAN who holds up her phone and we SEE who the MAN is: DR. KELLERMAN on her screen. About 65. Long white hair like DONALD SUTHERLAND.

KELLERMAN
We've arranged for you to have a
sabbatical at full pay, and deposited
a million dollars in your account.

YAN
Let me finish something first...

2. WIDE SHOT CHAMBER

YAN slams a weird multi-pronged CHINESE WIP against the STUDENT's flesh. Blood and torn skin.

3. INT. C/U YAN

YAN (CONT'D)
Fine. Send the car.

PAGE 26-27 (DOUBLE SPLASH FIVE PANELS)

LARGE UPPER PANEL

1. INT. QUANTUM COMPUTER LAB

https://newsroom.ibm.com/media-quantum-innovation?Keywords=quantum&l=100#gallery_gallery_0:22083

A lab with a large quantum computer. A SCIENTIST sits at a computer next to it. On screen: Tons of code.

SUBJECT: CYRUS MILLS: "Quantum cryptography expert, Aspergers Syndrome, 205 IQ, parents tortured and killed in Rwanda, escaped to the U.S. with severe undiagnosed PTSD, Warrior Gene, hacker, helps the FBI locate missing persons."

His phone rings.

2. C/U ON PHONE

It's KELLERMAN.

KELLERMAN

Convince me we made a wise investment
in you, Cyrus.

3. MEDIUM SHOT CYRUS

CYRUS points at the code running on his computer.

CYRUS

The algorithm can find anyone, or
make sure nobody ever get found.
Ready for the upload?

KELLERMAN

Yes.

3. INT. KELLERMAN'S OFFICE

KELLERMAN looks excited beyond measure as the various screen get overtaken by computer code and GPS graphics.

KELLERMAN (CONT'D)

Magnificent. Will you be joining
us?

4. C/U CYRUS

Packing his equipment in a briefcase.

CYRUS

So I get to kill anyone, anyone I
want - and I'll never get caught?

KELLERMAN
Your algorithm will help ensure that.

LARGE LOWER PANEL

5. INT. KELLERMAN'S OFFICE

KELLERMAN looks up at six huge video screens that show pictures of ASTRID, YAN, QUENTIN, SAMARA, THORNE and...CYRUS.

KELLERMAN (CONT'D)
Welcome to the Society of Killers.

PAGE 28-29 (DOUBLE SPLASH THREE LARGE PANELS)

1. WIDE SHOT SOCIETY OF KILLERS MAIN CAMPUS

The LIMO drives up a long twisty private road toward the facility entrance. A HELICOPTER with SAMARA hovers to a landing.

2. ENTRANCE TO CAMPUS

KELLERMAN, two mean-looking nurses and five muscle-bound orderlies in white uniforms are the welcome committee. Eight security guards with attack dogs.

All the main characters stand in front of the limo that just dropped them off.

ASTRID
Who's your architect? I want to cut his head off.

SAMARA
I get my own room, right?

QUENTIN
Tell your fucking guards to stand down.

THORNE
You're probably all wondering why I've called you here today? Heh-heh.

YAN
When do we start the training?

CYRUS
Yeah, how long before we get to kill?

3. WIDE WHOT THE WELCOMING COMMITTEE

KELLERMAN

First we'll have to make sure you
don't kill each other...